

BBC 6 Minute English Listening Practice

How Important Is Politeness?

Name: _____

Class: _____

Score: _____ / 20

No.	Sentence
1	The boy's greeting seemed to violate _____.
2	He used _____ because he recognised the person but could not recall his name.
3	The tag "innit" is a shortened form of _____.
4	The key issue was how the listener _____.
5	The greeting did not follow a more _____.
6	The listener treated the comment as _____.
7	He did not understand it as _____.
8	Politeness is linked to the _____.
9	Children learn it partly so they can be _____.
10	When a child failed to greet an adult, the parent began to _____.

11 **What main issue is raised by the boy's informal greeting?**

- A Whether famous people should accept slang in public conversations.
- B Whether politeness depends on interpretation as well as wording.
- C Whether children should be banned from using informal language.
- D Whether greetings are polite only when they include a person's name.

12 **Why did the boy use the word "thingy"?**

- A He wanted to insult the person by refusing to say his name.
- B He was quoting a phrase commonly used by young children.
- C He was unsure whether the person was actually famous.
- D He recognised the person but could not remember his name.

Answers written in the margins will not be marked.

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- 13 **How did the person addressed interpret the boy's greeting?**
- A He saw it as friendly rather than threatening or insulting.
 - B He considered it aggressive because of the missing name.
 - C He thought it was formally correct but emotionally cold.
 - D He felt it proved young people no longer learn manners.
- 14 **Why can the boy's words be judged differently by different listeners?**
- A The phrase "innit" has no meaning outside formal English.
 - B A formal greeting would have made the words less clear.
 - C Politeness depends partly on how the listener perceives them.
 - D Adults and children follow exactly the same social rules.
- 15 **What contrast is made between the boy's language and its effect?**
- A It was highly informal, yet it was not experienced as offensive.
 - B It was grammatically polished, yet it sounded socially distant.
 - C It used a person's full name, yet it still created confusion.
 - D It was intended as an insult, yet it produced no reaction.
- 16 **What opinion about teaching politeness is presented?**
- A Children should learn politeness only after they become adults.
 - B Politeness is mainly useful for avoiding punishment at school.
 - C Social rules matter less than a child's private intentions.
 - D Politeness helps children gain acceptance within society.
- 17 **In the expert's explanation, what does the "crucial thing" refer to?**
- A The exact slang word chosen by the boy.
 - B The way the listener understood the remark.
 - C The social status of the person in the street.
 - D The choice between formal and informal grammar.
- 18 **What can be inferred from the nursery-school incident?**
- A The cook was angry because the child spoke too informally.
 - B The parent believed greetings were unnecessary at that age.
 - C The child's silence felt like a failure to meet social expectations.
 - D The other children were embarrassed by the parent's reaction.

19 **Why is the nursery-school story included?**

- A To show how social pressure around children's manners is felt in practice.
- B To prove that very young children are naturally offensive to adults.
- C To argue that polite behaviour matters only inside schools.
- D To explain why adults should ignore children's bad behaviour.

20 **What overall implication does the discussion suggest?**

- A Politeness is fixed, so intention and context should be ignored.
- B Informal speech is normally more polite than formal language.
- C Teaching politeness is pointless because offence is subjective.
- D Politeness is subjective but still has real social value.